

Case Study - Holepunch / P2P

Motivation

Unlike traditional apps, P2P systems often lack centralized control, making it challenging to define sustainable monetization strategies, user incentives, and governance structures. By studying P2P apps architectures, this case study aims to uncover how these platforms create, capture, and distribute value, offering insights that can guide developers, entrepreneurs, and investors in building more resilient and impactful decentralized solutions.

Objective

This assignment will help you explore, analyze, and critically assess the business models and monetization strategies of peer-to-peer (P2P) applications.

Instructions

You are required to write a case study analyzing a specific peer-to-peer (P2P) application. This application can either be a theoretical alternative to an existing app or an entirely new concept of your own. While you are not expected to provide full technical implementation details, your case study should include enough technical context to demonstrate that your proposed approach is realistic and feasible. Additionally, you should outline a clear strategy for how the app could be monetized, how it would attract new users, and how it would keep them engaged over time.

Proposed structure

1. Introduction

- a. Brief background of the app and its context (market, users/roles, features, goals).
- b. Why is it considered P2P? Brief description of its architecture.

2. Value Proposition

- a. Who are the users on each side of the platform (supply/demand, peers)?
- b. What value does the app deliver to each group?

3. Business Model Analysis

- a. Describe how the app creates, delivers, and captures value.
- b. What is the incentive for the different users?

4. Monetization Strategy

- a. How does the platform generate revenue?

- b. What monetization techniques are used?
 - c. Are they aligned with the decentralized nature of the app?
- 5. Challenges & Risks**
 - a. Identify key risks (technical, legal, network effects, trust).
 - b. How do these affect monetization and scaling?
- 6. Your Assessment / Recommendations**
 - a. Is the monetization model sustainable and ethical?
 - b. Include a short reflection on how decentralization affects the business model.
- 7. References**
 - a. Do not forget to mention all external sources and data.

Additional notes

- Monetization through tokenization must be avoided. The app should not be monetized through tokenomics, nor should tokens be required for any feature.
- While a full P2P business model is preferred, a hybrid architecture is acceptable if a full P2P model limits the possibility of the sustainable success of the app.
- Remember, a P2P system can continue working even if the system owner goes completely offline.

Evaluation criteria

- Innovative approach
- Applicable in real world

Formatting

- Up to 10 pages
- PDF